Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Creative practice, studio roles and pathways

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do interdisciplinary creative groups take a structural commission from studio prototype to public installation?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why must a Lead artist and a Specialist fabricator share physical material prototypes (swatches and joint models) rather than only emails?

Correct: Physical prototypes prove how the real materials join, hold weight, and catch the light before full fabrication begins — Exactly! A hands-on joint and patina prototype eliminates guesswork.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Which specialist role checks that a cantilevered or arched structure will not sag, twist, or tip over? -> The structural Engineer, who checks triangulation, centre of gravity, and reinforced gusset joints (Correct. Engineering principles keep ambitious sculptures standing safely.)

Q2: What is a 'technical specification' alongside a studio prototype? -> Clear notes naming the exact materials, layer depths, joinery method, and surface finish recipe (Spot on. A

specification means anyone on the fabrication team can reproduce the quality consistently.)

Q3: How does learning to plan, prototype, and curate in this unit connect to post-16 creative pathways? -> It builds the core portfolio habits used in art & design, architecture, theatrical set construction, and museum curation (Yes! Every one of those pathways values brief-led prototyping and clear visual communication.)

Exit check answer

Question: What is the main purpose of building a physical joint and surface 'prototype' before starting the full-scale relief panel?

Correct: To test and prove that the structural joinery and surface patina recipe work reliably before committing to the full build — Correct. Prototyping solves technical problems early.